Jinho Kim

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Citizenship: South Korea | Website | LinkedIn

Education

Department of Economics, University of California, Davis — Davis, CA, USA
Ph.D. in Economics — 2021–2026
- Fields: Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Real Estate

Department of Economics, Yonsei University — Seoul, South Korea
B.A. in Economics — 2005–2013

Working Papers

1. **Who Captures the Rate Cut? Income, Attention, and the Refinancing Channel of Monetary Policy.** 2026. *Job Market Paper*. [Paper]

   Abstract: I document that lower-income households are far less likely to capture the gains from refinancing when interest rates fall, and I quantify how this gap affects the transmission of monetary policy. When refinancing is financially advantageous, bottom-income-quintile borrowers refinance 43 percent less often than the top quintile. They also take longer to act and respond less to monetary policy shocks, even though refinancing would lower their payments the most relative to income. I explain this gradient with a heterogeneous-agent model in which households choose how closely to monitor their mortgage. Differences in refinancing gains account for about one third of the income gradient, and the rest requires a price of attention that falls with income. A notification policy calibrated to field-experimental evidence raises the five-year consumption response to a rate cut by 12.3 percent, even after households reduce their own monitoring, with the largest proportional gains at the bottom of the income distribution.

2. **Demographics and Housing Booms** (with Yungu Cho, Hyunseo Park, Jaeyoung Yoo). 2026. [Paper]

Work in Progress

1. **Fixed-Rate Mortgages and the Cash-Flow Channel: Evidence from Rate Resets in Korea.** 2026.
2. **Local Projections Meet Big Data: Forecasting Nonlinear Economic Dynamics** (with James Cloyne, Òscar Jordà). 2026.
3. **Who Refinances, Who Spends? Refinancing Responsiveness and MPCs** (with Yungu Cho and Heejin Yoon). 2026.
4. **Mortgage Debt and the Consumption Response to Monetary Policy and Housing Wealth.** 2024.

Awards & Honors

Dean's Summer Support ($3,930), *UC Davis* — Aug. 2025
Department Research Award ($8,522), *UC Davis* — Dec. 2024
Department Travel Award ($5,000 in total), *UC Davis* — Jun. 2024 – Dec. 2025
Graduate Student Association Travel Grant ($500), *UC Davis* — May 2024
Doctoral Study Abroad Scholarship, *Bank of Korea* — Jun. 2020
Annual Thesis Competition (3rd place), *Bank of Korea* — Jun. 2016
Honors for Academic Excellence, *Yonsei University* — Fall 2009, Fall 2005

Presentations & Discussions

Presentations

WEAI Annual Conference, *Denver, USA* — Jun. 2026
AREUEA National Conference, *Washington, D.C., USA* — May 2026
American Finance Association Annual Meeting (poster), *Philadelphia, USA* — Jan. 2026
Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting, *Orlando, USA* — Nov. 2025
Financial Management Association Doctoral Consortium, *Vancouver, Canada* — Oct. 2025
World Congress of the Econometric Society, *Seoul, South Korea* — Aug. 2025
Journal of International Economics Summer School (poster), *University of Oxford* — Jul. 2024
Macro/International Lunchtime Presentation, *UC Davis* — May 2024; Mar. 2026

Discussant

"New Results on the Disparities between Same-Sex and Different-Sex Couples in the Home Mortgage Market," by Nir Eilam and Yeonjoon Lee
WEAI 101st Annual Conference, *Denver, USA* — Jun. 2026

"The Value of Mortgage Choice: Payment Structure and Contract Length," by Michael Boutros, Nuno Clara, and Katya Kartashova
Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting, *Orlando, USA* — Nov. 2025

Teaching & Research Experience

Research Assistant

Professor James Cloyne, Project: "State-Dependent Local Projections: Understanding Impulse Response Heterogeneity" — 2024

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, *UC Davis*

Macroeconomic Theory (Ph.D. Course) — 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Intermediate Macro, Principles of Macro/Micro, Money & Banking — 2021–2026

Employment

Bank of Korea | Economist — 2014–2021; 2026–Present
The Export-Import Bank of Korea | Investment Officer — 2013
Republic of Korea Air Force | Sergeant — 2007–2009

Policy Publications (Selected)

1. Euihwan Bae, **Jinho Kim**. Analysis of Stagnant Growth in the Service Industry of Daejeon. *Bank of Korea*, 2021.
2. **Jinho Kim**. Determinants of Chungnam Regional Export and Risk Factors. *Bank of Korea*, 2019.
3. Hyunman Kim, **Jinho Kim**. Labor Flexibility Effects on Employment and Productivity: Focusing on Classification of Flexibility. Award, *Bank of Korea Annual Thesis Competition*, 2016.
4. **Jinho Kim**, Yongbok Kim. Structural Changes in International Trade and Korea's Export. *Bank of Korea Economic Outlook*, 2015.
5. Youjung Cho, **Jinho Kim**, Yongbok Kim. The Impact on Korean Export of China's Policy to Restrain Processing Trade. *Bank of Korea Monthly Bulletin*, 2015.
6. **Jinho Kim**, Yongbok Kim. Analysis and Forecast of Korea's Export to China. *Bank of Korea Economic Outlook*, 2015.

Other Information

Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent).
Programming: Python, Julia, MATLAB, Stata
Citizenship: South Korea

References

James Cloyne (*Chair*)
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To request letters of recommendation by email, please contact the UC Davis Economics placement office at ucdecnjobmarket@ucdavis.edu. Staff will send the letters confidentially.

Research Abstracts

Working Papers

1. **Demographics and Housing Booms** (with Yungu Cho, Hyunseo Park, Jaeyoung Yoo). 2026. **[Paper]**

   We show that the age structure of the population systematically shapes housing-boom vulnerability. Across OECD countries and U.S. counties, a one-unit increase in the young-to-old ratio raises the probability of a large housing boom by 18.6 and 4.3 percentage points, respectively. In mortgage application data, young applicants increase their application intensity 4.3 to 6.6 percent more than older applicants during local booms, and after an identified credit-supply easing, house prices rise more, and more persistently, in younger areas. We then show that a life-cycle housing model accounts for the larger initial price response in younger economies, because young households are concentrated at the margin between owning and renting and respond most to credit easing.

Work in Progress

1. **Fixed-Rate Mortgages and the Cash-Flow Channel: Evidence from Rate Resets in Korea**. 2026.

   Korean hybrid mortgages reset automatically five years after origination on a predetermined date, and tight limits on cash-out borrowing make the reset a clean cash-flow shock. I exploit this quasi-experiment during the 2022–23 rate hikes, using a credit bureau panel. The MPC out of the higher interest payments is small, about 0.1, well below estimates from resets during rate cuts, because borrowers adjust mainly by refinancing or paying down their mortgages. However, liquidity-constrained borrowers are much less able to refinance or extend maturity, and they instead lose access to unsecured credit and cut card spending by about 3 percent relative to unconstrained borrowers. These results suggest that targeted access to refinancing and maturity extension can mitigate the distributional costs of monetary tightening.

2. **Local Projections Meet Big Data: Forecasting Nonlinear Economic Dynamics** (with James Cloyne, Òscar Jordà). 2026.

   We ask whether local projections can forecast nonlinear dynamics, such as crises, without overfitting. We select nonlinear interaction terms sparsely with LASSO and re-estimate the selected model. In out-of-sample forecasts of U.S. industrial production growth, the method is competitive with linear, Bayesian, factor, and penalized-regression benchmarks, and its downturn signals are the most precise at the one-month horizon.

3. **Who Refinances, Who Spends? Refinancing Responsiveness and MPCs** (with Yungu Cho and Heejin Yoon). 2026.

   The consumption effect of a rate cut depends on whether households that refinance quickly are the ones that spend the cash flow they gain. We plan to link the University of California Consumer Credit Panel to GSE loan performance data and HMDA, measure each borrower's revealed refinancing responsiveness and spending response, and enter their covariance into a sufficient statistic that extends the redistribution channel of Auclert (2019) to refinancing.

4. **Mortgage Debt and the Consumption Response to Monetary Policy and Housing Wealth.** 2024.

   This project exploits cross-regional heterogeneity in mortgage-ownership ratios to study how mortgage debt shapes consumption responses to monetary policy and housing wealth. Regions with higher mortgage exposure respond more strongly to interest rate cuts but less to housing wealth gains, consistent with liquidity constraints among wealthy hand-to-mouth households.